

pifanctl v1 Release Acceptance Field Manual

Status: Live v1 alpha runtime and thermal observations recorded through 2026-10-06 **Release target:** 1.0.0

- **Active deployment:** alpha.3 operator and worker; alpha.2 temperature agents
- **v1 candidate under review:** 1.0.0-alpha.3

Decision: Not ready for a stable release. Hardware-specific acceptance remains open.

This manual records MicroK8s trials, bounded temperature-response tests, measured evidence, and remaining release checks. The v1 alpha.3 CRD operator, worker, Fan, and CoolingZone are active for the shared rack. The 55°C test below passed its defined temperature-band stability criterion. A user visually confirmed normal fan rotation; RPM and electrical PWM measurements remain unavailable. Values unavailable from Kubernetes or direct measurements are explicitly marked **Not recorded** instead of being guessed.

1. Initial alpha.2 trial configuration (2026-10-04)

This inventory documents the earlier alpha.2 load trial. The active alpha.3 CRD operator and shared-rack worker are recorded in Sections 9 and 10.

Item	Observed value
Kubernetes context	microk8s
Trial namespace	pifanctl-v1-trial
Nodes	raspi-40, raspi-41, raspi-50, raspi-51
Node platforms	ARM64, Kubernetes v1.36.2, Debian GNU/Linux 12, Linux 6.12.93+rpt-rpi-* kernels
Known board labels	raspi-40 and raspi-41: Raspberry Pi 4 Model B; raspi-50: Raspberry Pi 5 Model B; raspi-51: model label not present
Operator / agent / worker image	ghcr.io/jyje/pifanctl-issue:887f6f1-py312
Image digest	sha256:525ef9f01f7bd4d5af5ac4d4014d9f0320187628c41cd2eacd028d5fbb896cf5
Source revision	887f6f1ff05301255e7a5f01e22e117ef8e8e9ef
Runtime chart	pifanctl chart 0.2.0-alpha.2; topology source preserved from 837b3d5
Image build	GitHub Actions run #25 , Python 3.12, passed
Current topology	One shared rack fan cools the four Nodes in CoolingZone r4spi-rack
Actuator	Fan r4spi-rack-fan on raspi-40, RPi.GPIO BCM pin 18, 1000 Hz
Curve	Idle 0%; starts at 30% at 50°C; reaches 100% at 70°C; downward changes are limited to 5 percentage points per refresh
Safety commands	Failsafe duty 100%; exit duty 100%; refresh every 5 seconds; worker heartbeat timeout 120 seconds
Topology hash	eb8b2a42289be4271f52103db3c7980ce5c9a0bb06fe83bc7f17d804b5c3f37c
Readiness	Argo CD Synced/Healthy; operator, four agents, worker, Fan, and CoolingZone reported Ready after rollout
Immediate image rollback	ghcr.io/jyje/pifanctl-issue:6a0f5a5-py312, runtime chart source 837b3d5; the archived v0 configuration remains the full rollback target

At the last recorded sample, 2026-10-04T13:23:40Z, the Fan resource reported a 51.25°C control temperature and a 34.375% requested duty. The measured node temperatures and Fan status vary over time; see the timestamped sample file rather than treating this point as a steady-state result.

2. Filled hardware inventory

The table describes the shared-fan controller during the initial 2026-10-04 trial. That workload ran on member raspi-41, which has no local fan in this topology. The later alpha.3 55°C run targeted raspi-51 and is recorded in Section 10.

Field	Recorded value
Controller Raspberry Pi model	Raspberry Pi 4 Model B, based on the Kubernetes node label; exact PCB revision not recorded
Controller OS, kernel, firmware	Debian GNU/Linux 12; kernel 6.12.93+rpt-rpi-v8; firmware version not recorded
Controller Node and UID	raspi-40; 2b557e96-e346-4e26-b053-04d3cfaa094e
Driver and PWM channel	RPi.GPIO, BCM GPIO 18, 1000 Hz
Fan manufacturer, model, rated voltage/current	Not recorded in Kubernetes; physical fan label or datasheet inspection required
Fan supply, fuse, and current limit	Not recorded; physical wiring and supply inspection required
PWM input type and polarity	Not recorded; verify from the exact fan datasheet and measured waveform
Ground/reference and signal wiring	Not recorded; inspect the physical rack
Independent hardware default and measured signal state	Not recorded; oscilloscope or logic-analyzer measurement required
Tachometer/RPM	No RPM metric or tachometer record was available
Visual rotation after the image update	User visually confirmed normal fan rotation before the 2026-10-06 load run; continuous observation during the load was not recorded; tachometer/RPM was not measured
Test member Node and UID	raspi-41; cabfc25d-6991-427c-a941-3ff323fd6531; Raspberry Pi 4 Model B label

100% is a requested PWM duty, not measured voltage, RPM, or proof that the fan has power. A floating input or GPIO HIGH must not be assumed to mean maximum cooling. No universal pull-up, pull-down, or polarity is prescribed. Verify a hardware safe default and independently powered fan circuit for the actual wiring. Software cannot correct fan-supply loss or mechanical failure.

3. Temperature-response test

Method and guardrails

- The live Fan stayed enabled throughout the CPU-load test. No CR, ConfigMap, Helm value, or temperature threshold was changed.
- Temporary, non-privileged CPU-load Pods were pinned to `raspi-41` and used the deployed candidate image. Each stage had a CPU and memory limit and exited automatically after its fixed duration.
- Prometheus temperatures and Fan status were sampled every 10 to 15 seconds. The load test was set to stop if any member reached 65°C or if temperature/status monitoring failed. Neither stop condition was reached.
- The 65°C abort threshold was a conservative test guardrail, not a pifanctl release setting. Raspberry Pi documents SoC thermal throttling between 80°C and 85°C; this test stayed well below that range. [Raspberry Pi hardware documentation](#)
- The raw records are in [thermal-load-observations.csv](#). They contain Prometheus CPU-thermal readings and contemporaneous Fan resource status. The Prometheus samples were fresh, with observed sample age below 1.1 seconds.
- The CSV has 68 observations from 2026-10-04T12:54:19Z through 2026-10-04T13:23:40Z. SHA-256: 78a3226fbfc82a8cced5c18061e08d256909d11a80333ae9def67f2ba81794f5.

Results

Stage	Applied load	Highest member reading	raspi-41 reading	Fan resource observation	Result
A	1 vCPU, up to 150 seconds	51.8°C	49.173°C maximum	Requested duty 29.375% to 36.3%	Partial; 55°C band not reached
B	2 vCPU, up to 120 seconds	52.35°C	50.147°C maximum	Requested duty reached 38.225%	Partial; brief readings only, no stable hold
C	3 vCPU, up to 120 seconds	55.1°C on raspi-51	49.173°C maximum	At control temperature 55.1°C, status requested 47.85%	Partial; hottest member was not the load target and did not remain at 55.1°C
D	Five-minute no-load observation, begun about seven minutes after the final stress stage	54.55°C maximum during the interval	Recorded separately in the CSV	Control temperature 49.05°C to 54.55°C; requested duty 17.45% to 45.925%	No stable plateau established; this delayed interval does not measure the immediate cooldown transient

The expected steady-state commands from the configured curve are 30% at 50°C, 47.5% at 55°C, 65% at 60°C, 82.5% at 65°C, and 100% at 70°C. The trial reached a short 55.1°C control-temperature snapshot and reported 47.85%, consistent with the configured curve. It did not reach 60°C or higher, and no temperature band was held long enough to claim thermal stabilization.

The test is not an isolated causal measurement. The hottest readings came from raspi-51, not the stress target raspi-41, and the cluster hosts other services. The stress target peaked at 50.147°C, while the hottest rack member peaked at 55.1°C. A later `kubecttl top nodes` sample showed about 19% CPU on both raspi-40 and raspi-41, and about 6% on raspi-50 and raspi-51, after the load had ended. The data demonstrate changing cluster telemetry and corresponding Fan status, but they do not prove that the injected load alone caused the raspi-51 temperature peak.

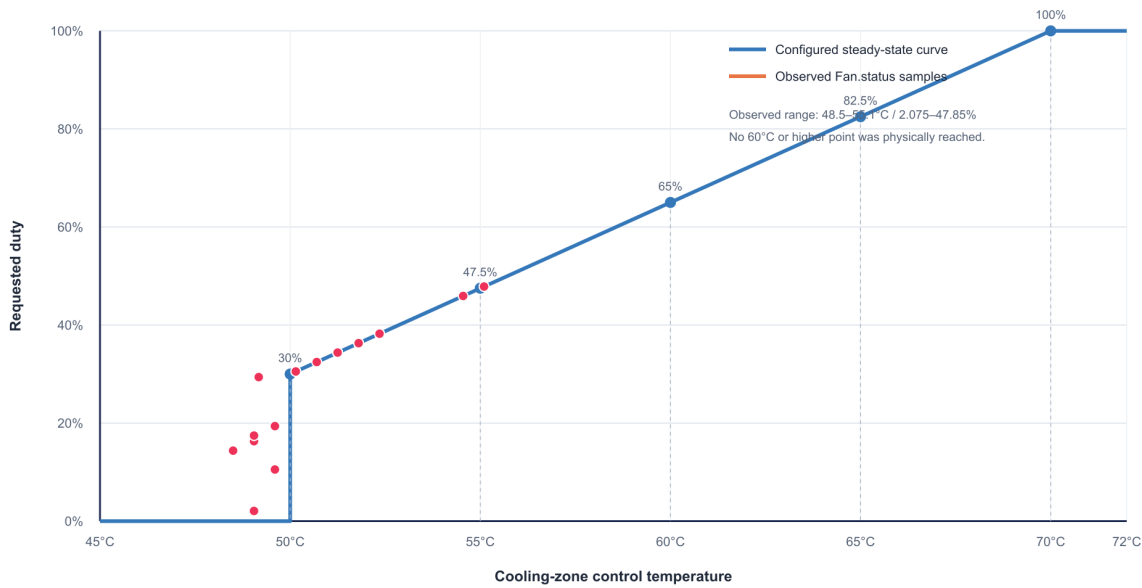
Measured MicroK8s temperature and fan-command response



This figure plots the node selected for load, the concurrently hottest node, the cluster maximum, the Fan status control temperature, and the requested duty. Gaps between test stages remain gaps in time. Fan status is not measured PWM voltage or RPM.

Configured control curve and observed duty commands

Hypothesis: linear increase from 30% at 50°C to 100% at 70°C; actual status includes the 5% per-refresh down-step.



The solid line is the configured rising curve. Markers are observed Fan status snapshots. The downward ramp can lag the curve because the configured controller limits each decrease to 5 percentage points per refresh. Target points at 60°C and above are curve calculations, not live measurements.

Stability criteria and interpretation

Call a temperature band stable only after the hottest member stays within a 1°C range for at least 120 seconds under a declared, repeatable workload, telemetry remains fresh, and requested duty has no unexplained increase. Record fan RPM when instrumentation is available, or direct visual rotation. The initial 2026-10-04 trial did not satisfy that criterion. The later alpha.3 55°C run passed it as recorded in Section 10. In the initial trial, the member temperatures varied independently, and the hottest member was outside the node receiving the test load. Its five-minute no-load interval began about seven minutes after the last CPU-load sample, so it is not evidence for the immediate cooling slope or time-to-stability.

The live test ended below the 65°C abort guardrail, all temporary load Pods were removed, and no trial configuration was changed. The physical-fan-stop and recovery test has **not** been run. Its safe abort threshold is awaiting confirmation; the hardware default, RPM, and post-upgrade physical rotation also remain unverified.

4. Other scenario records

Scenario	Current evidence	Status
Normal shared-rack regulation	Fan and CoolingZone Ready; Fan status follows the hottest available member samples and reports requested duty	Observed; 55°C stability target passed in Section 10
Local node CPU load	Capped stages on <code>raspi-41</code> plus a 1 vCPU capped run on <code>raspi-51</code> ; see Sections 3, 7, and 10	55°C target passed; other target bands remain untested or partial
Temperature missing or stale	The worker is configured for fail-safe 100%; no live telemetry fault was injected	Not run live; automated mock/API scenarios cover this behavior
Operator heartbeat expires	Worker plan uses a 120-second heartbeat timeout and fail-safe 100%; no live heartbeat fault was injected	Not run live
Physical shared fan stopped, then restored	No stop command or fan-power interruption was applied; actual fan circuit default is not yet documented	Not run; safety guardrail confirmation pending
Controller process exit, reboot, or power loss	No live fault was injected; process and electrical defaults need measurement	Not run
Pi 5 PWM hardware	<code>raspi-50</code> is labelled Pi 5 Model B, but the trial fan actuator uses RPi.GPIO on Pi 4 <code>raspi-40</code>	Not run on Pi 5 hardware

The examples below describe expected control behavior, not measured thermal traces:

- **Normal load:** the shared fan follows the hottest member. A hotter member raises the shared fan request while cooler members remain in the same CoolingZone.
- **One hot member:** the selected zone's fan should rise along the configured curve; unrelated zones should not change.
- **Missing temperature or expired heartbeat:** the affected worker should request 100% and report an unhealthy reason. No thermal rise is predicted here because the live faults were not injected.
- **Fan stops or loses supply:** a software duty command cannot guarantee cooling. The measured hardware default and restoration behavior must be recorded before this scenario can pass.

5. Remaining release procedures

Pi 4 GPIO PWM waveform and physical behavior

Record the actual board revision, OS/firmware, fan part number, supply/current protection, wiring, polarity, voltage levels, and instrument setup. With a person at the hardware, capture startup, requested duty changes, fan start-from-rest, normal stop, and process termination. Repeat at least three cold starts and three normal stops. **Pass only when measured waveform and physical fan behavior agree with the fan datasheet at all tested points.**

Pi 5 kernel PWM

Verify the actual overlay, PWM chip/channel, pin mux, polarity, and frequency on the physical Pi 5. The sample `chip: 0, channel: 2` in `design/v1/examples/sysfs.yaml` is illustrative. Check single-writer ownership and repeat startup, duty, reboot, and shutdown measurements. Do not infer a Pi model or pin map from a Node name.

Process, reboot, power, and network faults

In an isolated maintenance window, test graceful stop and SIGKILL separately, then orderly reboot, abrupt controller power loss, fan-supply interruption, worker/operator partition, and Prometheus loss. Record physical rotation, scope/tachometer data, failsafe time, `/readyz`, status reason, and recovery. Never count Python cleanup as protection against SIGKILL.

Migration, rollback, and fleet load

Capture the archived v0 configuration and checksum. Inventory every writer of each PWM channel. Compare a read-only v1 plan to the physical rack, keep cooling at the safe state during handover, stop the old writer and verify lock release before starting v1, then exercise rollback. Measure CPU/memory, API requests, reconciliation duration, status writes, Prometheus latency, scrape gaps, and heartbeat age at a declared fleet size.

6. Evidence and release decision

Record	Candidate and method	Result	Evidence
Deployment	887f6f1-py312, digest recorded in Section 1	Argo CD Synced/Healthy; Fan and CoolingZone Ready	Workflow run #25
Load stage A	raspi-41, 1 vCPU, maximum 150 seconds	Partial; maximum zone sample 51.8°C	Raw samples
Load stage B	raspi-41, 2 vCPU, maximum 120 seconds	Partial; maximum zone sample 52.35°C	Raw samples
Load stage C	raspi-41, 3 vCPU, maximum 120 seconds	Partial; 55.1°C transient on raspi-51; no steady hold	Raw samples
Cooldown	Five-minute no-load observation, started about seven minutes after the final load sample	Not stable; immediate cooldown transient was not captured	Raw samples
Electrical waveform, RPM, and physical fan-off recovery	No instruments or completed post-upgrade observation recorded	Not run	Physical acceptance evidence required
Pi 5 hardware, fault injection, rollback, fleet scale	No live trial records	Not run	Procedures in Sections 5 and 3
2026-10-06 live shared-fan follow-up	alpha.2 chart and image; bounded member CPU load	Response observed; 61.15°C sample crossed the 60°C stage gate, so load was stopped; no stable hold claimed	Follow-up samples and Section 7
2026-10-06 isolated alpha.3 CRD runtime probe	alpha.3 operator chart and Python 3.12 ARM64 issue image in a temporary namespace; probe CRs targeted nonexistent Nodes	CRD defaulting/admission, operator reconciliation, expected missing-node status, and Argo health passed; no worker or GPIO access	Workflow run 37429082468 and Section 8

7. 2026-10-06 live shared-fan follow-up

This bounded follow-up exercised the currently deployed `ghcr.io/jyje/pifanctl:v1.0.0-alpha.2` controller from chart `0.2.0-alpha.2` on the four-node `microk8s` cluster. The Argo CD application was Synced and Healthy before the run. The shared fan controller stayed Ready on `raspi-40`; four agents continued publishing temperatures. A checksum-verified snapshot of the current GitOps application, chart, DaemonSets, Pods, monitoring objects, and node inventory was captured before applying load. No Helm values, ConfigMaps, CRDs, PWM settings, or production workloads were changed.

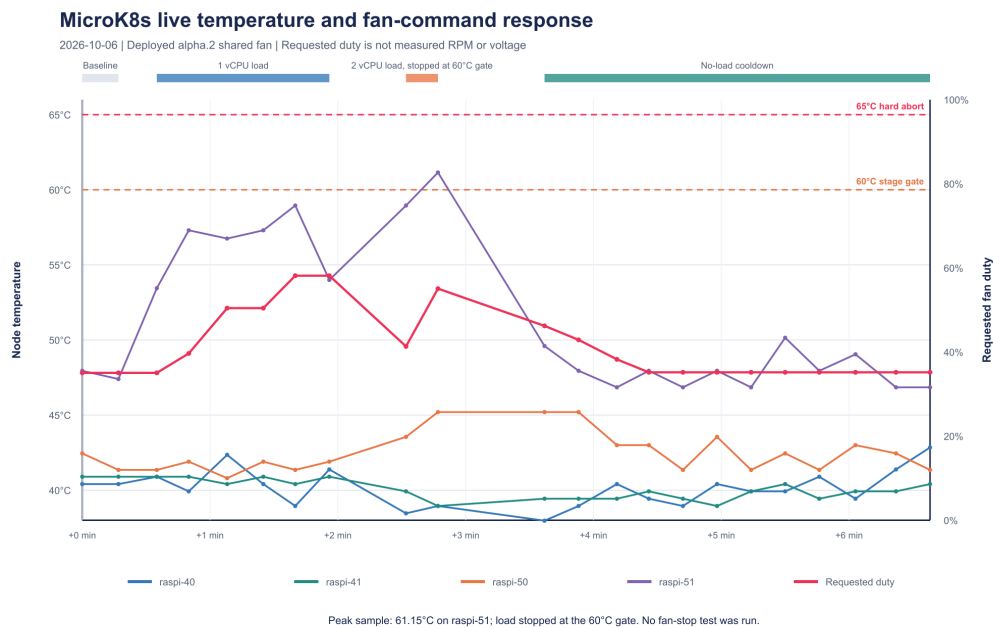
Two unprivileged Pods were pinned to the hottest member, `raspi-51`, and used the deployed image with CPU and memory limits. The 1 vCPU stage ran for 85 seconds. A 2 vCPU stage was started, then deleted as soon as a 15-second Prometheus poll observed the 60°C stage gate. The load harness also stopped on stale or missing telemetry, an unavailable controller, or a 65°C hard abort guardrail. Because the threshold is evaluated at polling intervals and thermal sensors report with delay, the sampled value reached 61.15°C before the Pod was removed. The 65°C abort limit was not reached.

Observation	Result
Baseline hottest member	raspi-51, 47.95°C; requested duty 35.04%
1 vCPU stage	Peak 58.95°C; requested duty reached 58.14%; Pod exited after 85 seconds
2 vCPU stage	Sampled peak 61.15°C; requested duty 55.06%; stopped at the 60°C stage gate and Pod removed
No-load follow-up	12 samples over 3 minutes; raspi-51 was 46.85°C in the final sample, with requested duty 35.18%
Monitoring and controller	Four node series remained fresh; maximum observed sample age was under 4 seconds; controller stayed Ready

Observation	Result
Cleanup	Both temporary load Pods were absent after the run; GitOps and production configuration were unchanged

These observations show the shared controller's requested duty rising while the hottest member warmed and falling during cooldown. They do not establish a stable target-temperature hold, prove that injected CPU load alone caused every temperature change, or measure electrical PWM, fan RPM, or airflow. The exact board model for `raspi-51` remains unrecorded. No fan-stop, fault-injection, reboot, or power-loss test was run. Fan rotation was not directly observed during this remote follow-up.

Raw timestamped samples, including the aborted-stage observation and cooldown, are in [thermal-load-observations-2026-10-06.csv](#). The plot separates each node's temperature from the requested fan duty and marks both the 60°C stage gate and 65°C hard abort limit.



The live experiment is a response check for the deployed alpha.2 shared-fan topology only. It does not validate the v1 CRD operator, Pi 5 PWM, fail-safe behavior after hardware or process faults, electrical signal polarity, or physical cooling capacity.

8. 2026-10-06 isolated alpha.3 CRD runtime probe

An isolated Argo CD Application installed the operator chart from `pifanctl` commit `69a829f2bb17977b692954c905129498d63abcf7` into namespace `pifanctl-v1-runtime-test`. The chart established the cluster-scoped Fan and CoolingZone CRDs, and Kubernetes admitted both probe resources. API defaulting added `temperatureHysteresis: 5` to the Fan. The probe used the commit-specific ARM64 Python 3.12 image `ghcr.io/jyje/pifanctl-issue:69a829f-py312`, built and smoke-tested by [workflow run 37429082468](#). The deployed image digest was `sha256:1bbee7f514a3547ac9c0b1413f159f077f4ed90821ff2d39080119f3cd528115`.

Check	Observed result
CRD installation and admission	Both CRDs established; Fan and CoolingZone creation succeeded
Operator image and API connection	One operator Pod Ready, zero restarts, no recurring reconciliation errors
Argo CD	Synced and Healthy
Missing-node conditions	Fan reported <code>MissingWorkerNode</code> ; CoolingZone reported <code>MissingNode</code> , as expected
Worker and GPIO	No worker Pod was created; no GPIO-capable workload ran
Cleanup	Argo pruned both probe resources; the probe Application and namespace were deleted
Production <code>pifanctl</code> after staged handoff	Alpha.2 agent DaemonSet remains 4/4; its controller DaemonSet was pruned. The alpha.3 staging operator is 1/1 Ready; no Fan resource or worker exists

The first probe attempt used alpha.2 with the alpha.3 CRD. Kubernetes defaulted the new hysteresis field, which the older alpha.2 topology schema rejected. The alpha.3 Python 3.12 image then reconciled the same probe successfully. This confirms the need to keep the operator image and CRD revision compatible; it does not establish cross-version compatibility.

This is live MicroK8s API and operator-runtime evidence, not the disposable-cluster test, a worker startup test, physical PWM/RPM verification, or temperature stabilization acceptance. The CRDs remain installed cluster-wide after the isolated resources and namespace were removed. The staged GitOps handoff is now active: [PR #144](#) installed the alpha.3 operator with no extraResources; [PR #145](#) disabled the alpha.2 controller; [PR #146](#) enabled app-scoped pruning so the old DaemonSet and Pod were removed. The live rack topology was subsequently added through [PR #147](#). See the next section for worker and telemetry evidence. Preserve the archived baseline for rollback.

9. 2026-10-06 alpha.3 shared rack worker

The GitOps change in [cluster PR #147](#), merged as 53fdb9f86cc4b85974e4e410121f2f3dd2bfc810, declares r4spi-rack-fan on raspi-40 using RPi.GPIO BCM GPIO18 at 1000 Hz. CoolingZone r4spi-rack groups raspi-40, raspi-41, raspi-50, and raspi-51, reads pifanctl_temperature_celsius from the in-cluster Prometheus service, and keeps the existing 50-75 C curve, 5 C hysteresis, 5-second refresh, and 100% failsafe and exit duties.

Check	Observed result
GitOps	Argo CD pifanctl-v1-staging Synced and Healthy after PR #147
Fan and CoolingZone admission	Both resources created; zone resolved all four nodes and one fan
Worker placement and readiness	One worker Pod on raspi-40, Ready, zero restarts
Fan status	Ready=True, reason Regulating; requested duty started at 100% and entered closed-loop control
Zone telemetry	Fresh Prometheus samples from all four nodes; zone Ready=True
Unforced observation	At 2026-10-06 11:11:44 UTC, temperatures were raspi-40 41.381 C, raspi-41 41.381 C, raspi-50 44.65 C, and raspi-51 50.7 C. The worker reported a 50.7 C zone maximum and 45.96% requested duty.

The unforced observation confirms that the alpha.3 worker reconciles the real Fan and CoolingZone, collects rack-wide node temperatures, and changes its requested duty as the measured zone temperature changes. It is not a controlled load test or a stable target-temperature hold. The brief 65 C control reading during startup was followed by lower readings as the worker entered its control loop; it was not a staged thermal stimulus. No CPU load, fan-stop, fault injection, or target-curve modification was performed in this run.

The requested duty is a software command, not a tachometer or airflow measurement. The user visually confirmed normal rotation after the image update, but no tachometer/RPM or electrical waveform was measured. The bounded 55°C run and its remaining limitations are recorded in Section 10. Keep the archived v0 configuration available for rollback.

10. 2026-10-06 alpha.3 55°C shared-rack stability run

After the user confirmed that the physical shared fan was rotating normally, a bounded thermal-response run exercised the active v1 alpha.3 Fan and CoolingZone on MicroK8s. The worker controlled one shared fan on raspi-40 for the four-member rack zone. A non-privileged Pod with a 1 vCPU limit was pinned to raspi-51, the hottest member at baseline. The fan remained enabled throughout. No Fan, CoolingZone, ConfigMap, Helm, or GPIO settings were changed.

The load stage was capped at 180 seconds. The harness sampled the worker status and each Prometheus source-observation timestamp, accepted only fresh telemetry, and removed the load if the source became stale, the worker became unhealthy, or the rack maximum reached its 58°C soft stop or 62°C hard stop. The configured temperature band for this target was 54–56°C. The acceptance criterion was at least 120 continuous seconds within that band, with fresh source telemetry and no unexplained change in requested duty. A 65°C ceiling remained the absolute test guardrail.

Measurement	Result
Baseline hottest member	raspi-51, 49.05°C; 36.58% requested duty
Applied load	1 vCPU CPU limit on raspi-51; maximum load duration 180 seconds
Load-stage peak	57.3°C; requested duty peaked at 50.44%; neither the 58°C soft stop nor 62°C hard stop was reached
Stable target interval	23 fresh observations from 2026-10-06 14:22:48 UTC through 14:25:12 UTC; 144 seconds in the 54–56°C band

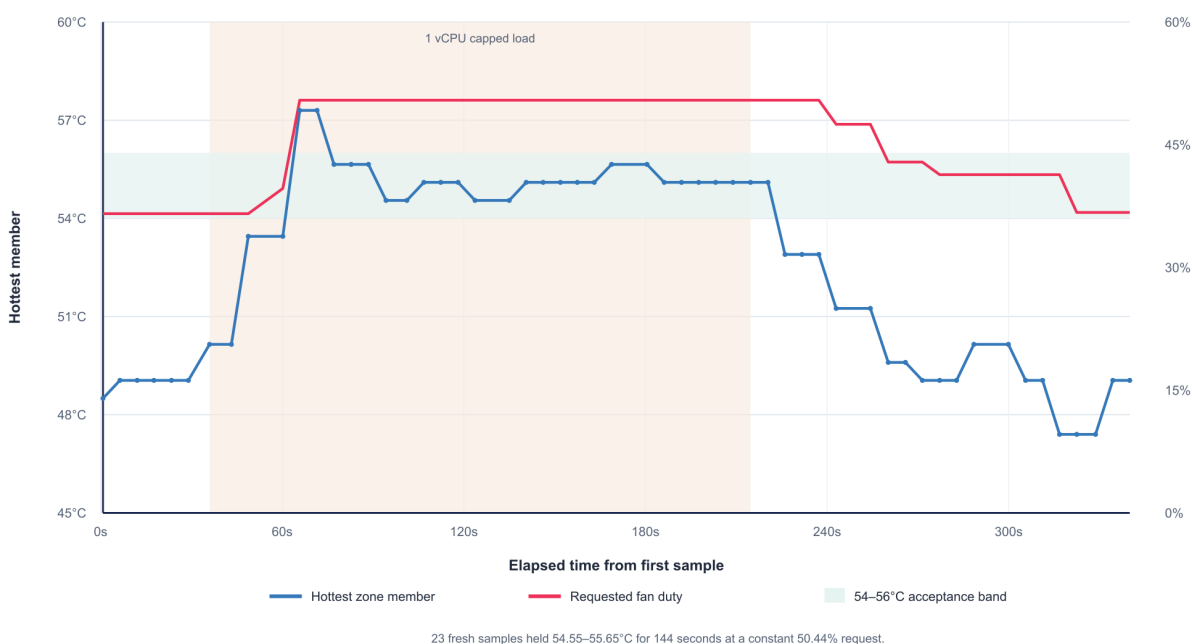
Measurement	Result
Temperature and requested duty in the interval	54.55–55.65°C; fixed at 50.44% requested duty (0 percentage-point span)
Telemetry freshness	Maximum observed source age for the full run was 17.83 seconds; longest gap between stable-interval source observations was 10 seconds
Physical fan observation	User confirmed normal rotation before the load; continuous observation during the run was not recorded. No RPM/tachometer measurement or electrical PWM waveform was recorded
Cooldown and cleanup	After load removal, the hottest member returned to 47.4–49.05°C in the recorded cooldown window. The temporary load Pod was absent on follow-up. Operator and worker were Ready with zero restarts; Fan and CoolingZone were Ready.

This run **passes the 55°C temperature-band stability criterion** for the tested alpha.3 runtime and rack configuration. It does not prove measured RPM, airflow, PWM voltage/polarity, or fan-failure detection. The initial rise to 57.3°C and the later sensor readings are part of the observed response, not a claim that the entire load stage stayed at the target. Only the 55°C target was tested with this criterion; 50°C and 60°C target runs remain open. The cooldown samples demonstrate a return toward baseline but are not a calibrated cooling-capacity or time-to-stability measurement.

The retained [CSV](#) contains host sample time, source-observation time, each member temperature, hottest member, control temperature, requested duty, source age, and worker-heartbeat age. SHA-256: 071f9ed3a9833e618ac43c0f393a442c624133aef7c20e8cd0ce2e56dbcf8a9b. Regenerate the [figure](#) and this PDF with `python scripts/build_release_acceptance.py`.

Measured 55°C shared-rack response

Fresh source observations from the v1 worker; requested duty is a command, not measured RPM or PWM voltage.



Do not label 1.0.0 stable until every applicable release gate has evidence for the exact release candidate. Hardware or topologies not tested must be listed as unsupported. Preserve the v0 rollback archive until the release decision is recorded.

References

- [Runtime manual](#), [v1 architecture and acceptance design](#), and [implementation and release checklist](#)
- [Raspberry Pi frequency and thermal management](#), [RPi.GPIO project](#), and [Linux kernel PWM interface](#)